

Email is one lever.

There are 13 more most founders don't use.

The full toolkit

Retention isn't a channel. It's a system with 14 levers.

Here they are — ranked by ROI for AI SaaS at \$100K ARR.

Levers 1–3: Foundation

- Email list management
- Welcome sequence
- Post-purchase onboarding

Levers 4–6: Behavioral

- RFM segmentation
- Churn prediction
- Behavioral triggers

Levers 7–9: Commercial

- Pricing as retention
- Upgrade paths
- Loyalty programs

Levers 10–12: Relational

- **Community building**
- **Referrals**
- **User-generated content**

Levers 13–14: Operational

- Proactive support
- AI + human workflows

The 3 that move the needle

For AI SaaS at \$100K ARR specifically:

- 1. Post-purchase onboarding**
- 2. RFM segmentation**
- 3. Pricing as retention**

#1 Post-purchase onboarding

First 7 days decide if a user churns.

Most AI SaaS use those days to do nothing.

#2 RFM segmentation

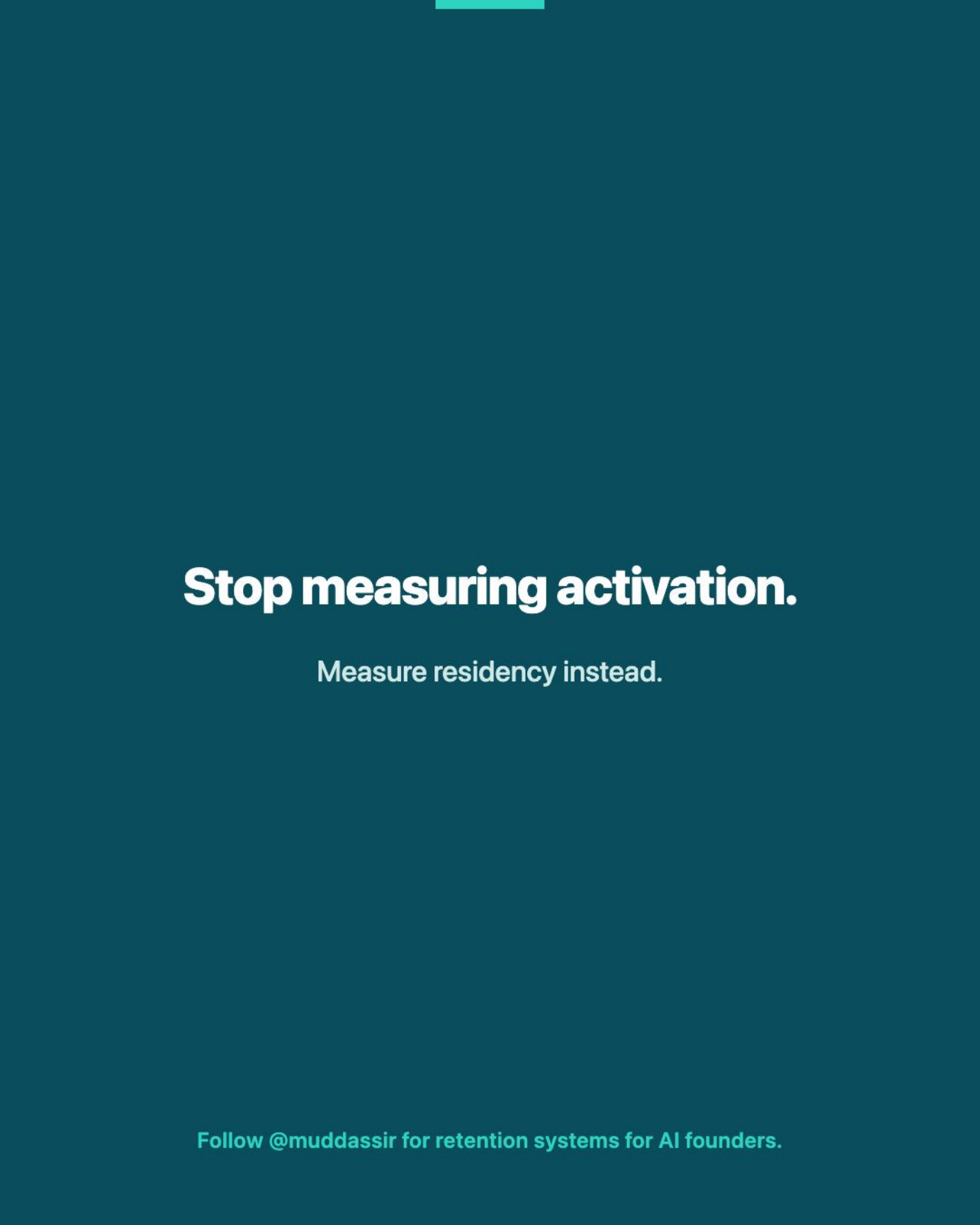
Your top 10% by recency + frequency + monetary value are worth 10x average.

Tag them. Treat them differently.

#3 Pricing as retention

Pricing is a retention lever, not an acquisition lever.

Tiered plans, annual discounts, usage-based pricing — all built to increase resident time.



Stop measuring activation.

Measure residency instead.

Follow [@muddassir](#) for retention systems for AI founders.